being passed down to them. This dormant organization was kick-started and a few meetings and rallies were held thereafter. There is now a functional but ad-hoc set up for the ESM to take care of their needs. As proposed by me, a state-level rally was held on 4 December 2010 where we were able to get to know the veteran's problems. On the occasion, the chief minister, Dorjee Khandu, assured the gathering that he would create a full-fledged state soldiers board and look into the issues raised by the veterans. We have held a number of recruitment rallies to encourage the youth to join the armed forces and contain the rising unemployment. Besides that I have been pushing to raise additional NCC units, including a naval wing. We are hopeful that under the leadership of Lieutenant General P.S. Bhalla, the desired expansion of the NCC in Arunachal Pradesh would become a reality.

On 30 April 2011, a shocking and unfortunate event took place. Chief Minister Dorjee Khandu's helicopter took off from Tawang at 9.56 a.m. and ran into bad weather around the Se La pass. The chopper lost contact with the base and went missing. The spell of exceptionally heavy weather with snow and rain hampered search and rescue operations for the next few days. The crash site and the bodies were located after an intense search of four days. Dorjee Khandu had come to symbolize the strength of our democratic traditions, having served in the army and rising from the social fabric of Arunachal to become the chief minister for a second term. His humanitarian values, humility and simplicity endeared him to all. He will be remembered as one of the finest chief ministers the state has seen.

The Congress legislative party met on 5 May 2011 to elect a new leader. After hectic parleys, Jarbom Gamlin was chosen as the next chief minister. He was very close to Dorjee Khandu and soon after his swearing in, announced that he would complete the projects and plans undertaken by his predecessor. The swearing in of his council of ministers was conducted on 20 May. Unfortunately, Jarbom Gamlin's tenure was cut short due to political turbulence caused by various factors. Dissent against his government kept increasing by the day. Finally, after a period of uncertainty coupled with law and